Murdle on the Orient Express

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General Audiences

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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wordle, Alternate Universe - Modern Setting, Modern Universe- Athletes, they're all professional athletes and human disasters, who make tiktoks together, thats it that's the au, Simplicity

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by PointlesslyPoetic

Summary

Adora is an excellent MMA fighter. She is not a great scholar. Will that prevent her from winning today's Wordle? Yeah probably.

Notes

First one shot in a new sandbox I'm playing in! Modern AU, everyone is a professional athlete and they all train at the same Megaplex together. This was fun and I def plan on writing more here.

See the end of the work for more notes

“Is it ‘roman’?”

“I’m not telling you.”

“Is it…’pesto’?”

“I’m not telling you.”

“Is it-”

“What part of this isn’t clicking for you?”

“Oh my god, can you two move on from the damn Wordle? It’s been twenty minutes!” Glimmer groaned, dragging her hand down her face in exasperation as her two closest friends continued to bicker about the daily puzzle. They were running late for an “Alliance” brunch, and to make things worse, people were starting to stare at the now–arguing women behind her. Glimmer walked a bit faster, hoping people would start assuming she wasn’t with them.

“Hey, Glimmer-” Or not.

“What, Adora?”

“Is it ‘trove’?”

Glimmer shot Adora a baleful glance. “None of these words are remotely similar. Have you even guessed once?”

“...I get nervous?”

Luckily, she didn’t have to deign the blonde with an answer, as they had arrived at Thaymoor, the favored brunch spot of the Alliance. The rest of the group was already inside at their usual rounded booth, most still in their practice or workout gear from the morning, tapping away at their phones.

It had been their managers’ idea, getting the most promising young athletes in the Bright Moon area to start hanging out,

networking, all that boring professional bullshit. It had been their collective idea to start making Tiktoks, duetting and reacting and collaborating on everything they could think of, capitalizing on the latest trends. It had resulted in a fast-track to the spotlight of the internet-watching world, and no small amount of feuds that were finally reaching their end, much to the gossip rags' disappointment.

Seating at the table were Bow, Scorpia, Perfuma, Mermista, Sea Hawk, and Frosta. Entrapta, Netossa, and Spinnerella had begged off, needing to take the rest of the Saturday to make sure the Athletic Megaplex was set up for the following week's events. They all made some acknowledgement as the three late-comers sat, nods or smiles or vague grunts.

"How was morning practice for you guys?"

Mermista just groaned, long and low, and let her head thunk to the table top. Bow smiled. "Good! Coach thinks I'm all set for States this week, so this afternoon's block is just Weight Room." Bow was an archer, arguably the best in the region, and was by far the least jaded of any of them (except maybe Sea Hawk, but Glimmer was pretty sure that was more from ignorance than passion). He never, ever seemed down or discouraged after practice, something she had no small amount of envy for. His Tiktok followers had dubbed him Sunshine.

"That's great, Bow!" Glimmer smiled genuinely for the first time that day, and placed a hand on his (very, very toned) forearm. "I'm happy for you."

"I got knocked out during my first match." Scorpia spoke around a mouthful of 'breakfast popcorn' that came complimentary. Thaymoor was weird. "But Coach Huntara said I was only asleep for, like, two minutes! That's a new record."

Perfuma eyed her girlfriend with open concern. "That's great, sweetie! I think…"

They had become the internet's favorite "cottage-core" (Glimmer had had to google that) daydream overnight, shocking no one. Individually, Perfuma posted Krav Maga self-defense tutorials for women, and Scorpia showed her followers the best way to bulk, or cut, or posted self-esteem boosting daily affirmations. Together, though, their collaborations focused on mental wellness, communication in relationships, and romantic date night ideas for busy couples. They were the Domestic Lesbian Dream, and the internet ate it up.

"Is it…Trout?"

"Adora, oh my god."

Bow glanced around Glimmer and smirked. "Is she trying to do the Wordle?"

"Trying is a very generous word." Catra sighed. The waitress took that moment to come over and take their coffee orders- tea, for Perfuma- all artisan beans and oatmilk. It was their one collective dietary indulgence; athletes at any level of competitive performance had their routine diet set by the time they hit puberty, and rarely strayed. In fact, most of them preferred to cook at home and control their macros and nutrients themselves, but, well, Thaymoor's had an undeniably good breakfast quinoa bowl, and the lighting was selfie-perfect.

"Ch…chert!" Adora's exclamation brought several pairs of eyes to their table, and Glimmer groaned.

"Adora-"

"Fuck!"

"Your first guess was 'chert'?" Mermista's dry snort gave Adora's frustration a target.

"Well what's your Wordle score, smart ass?"

"Two."

“Fuck off.” Adora flipped her off and went back to concentrating on her puzzle. Mermista chuckled and went back to her…

“What the hell are you doing?” Glimmer craned her neck to see Mermista’s phone, where it looked like she was playing four word games at once. Belatedly, she clocked the pad of paper Mermista was scribbling gibberish on.

“Quordle.”

Catra snapped up to give her a disgusted look. “What in god’s name is Quordle.”

“Four Wordles at once.”

“...why.”

Mermista just rolled her eyes and went back to scribbling. “Wordle’s boring. This one makes it interesting.”

“Damn it!” Adora’s outburst cut through the conversation again. Scorpia reached over with her still-wrapped grip to touch the blonde’s shoulder.

“‘Dora? You alright?”

“It’s not ‘Snide’.”

Bow smothered a chuckle when Catra groaned. “Earth to Greyskull, the E from ‘Chert’ was grayed out!”

“Oh, yeah. Oops.”

Glimmer turned to their resident pyromaniac-slash-fencer, whose head was bowed over his own daily puzzle game, but instead of words, she saw… “Sea Hawk, is that math Wordle?”

“Hm?” He looked up, and when he realized someone was speaking, popped his airpods out of his ears. “Sorry, I was listening to this new sea chanty-”

“Do not start.” Mermista groaned, but Sea Hawk just smiled.

“But dearest, the fiddles!”

“Fuck your fiddles. And don’t call me that.”

“Of course, dearest,” Sea Hawk turned back to Glimmer. “It’s Nerdle!”

Catra perked up at that. “Ohhh, I wanna try!”

“I’ll send you link!”

“Kay, lemme unblock you real quick.” Catra flicked through her contacts to do just that while Glimmer swallowed a snort. Sea Hawk was routinely blocked and unblocked by just about everyone in the group, save for Scorpia, his roommate and best friend, and Bow, his co-worker, best friend, and former amicable hookup. At least, Glimmer assumed it was former, with how close he and Mermista were currently sitting, one of her muscular legs thrown over his.

She wasn’t gonna touch that today, she had enough to cope with with-

“Oh! Oh! ‘Farce’ is kinda close.”

Glimmer leaned over to check Adora’s phone. “Well…sort of. You’ve got A, R, and C in the wrong spots but they’re there.”

Catra leaned over on Adora’s other side. “Wait- Adora, the S from Snide is in the right spot! It’s green!”

“Oh, shit,” Adora frowned. “Okay, so, S, A, C, R… is ‘sacre’ a word?”

“In French!” Perfuma supplied. The waitress interrupted again, dropping off drinks and taking food orders, handling their many, many modifications with grace. By the time she vanished, Adora was groaning again. “It won't take ‘Sacre’.”

“Okay, well, you’ve got two more shots.” Catra leaned in even closer, and Glimmer smirked, meeting Bow’s eyes from where he sat next to Catra. He wiggled his eyebrows, nodding to their practically snuggling friends, and she suppressed a giggle.

“C…Craft?”

“There’s no S in craft.” Catra sighed again, but it was undeniably fond, and shockingly patient.

“S..Sract…?”

Catra chuckled. “How often do you get hit in the head, dummy?”

“Not that often.” Adora pouted.

“So you’re just organically stupid?”

“Hey!” Catra’s raspy, squeaky laugh was an oddity even now, after all the drama of their late-teen years had been left behind. Adora jostled her friend (crush? Probably.) with one large bicep, almost bowling the lithe gymnast out of her chair. Adora had been shredded even before competing in the professional MMA circuits; now, it was almost comical how strong she had become.

“Help me!” Adora whined, though the effect was lessened by her laughter.

“Alright, alright.” Catra tucked herself against Adora, which drew even Mermista’s subtly impressed attention. She nodded approvingly to herself before returning to her Quordle. “Think. You’ve got S and C and R, so they have to be attached somewhere…”

“Hmmm,” Adora chewed her lip. “Um…S…scram?” Before Catra could open her mouth, Adora punched it in. She frowned at the lack of victory stats popping up on her screen.

“Okay, well, you know that the S and C are correct, and that there’s no M,” Catra encouraged, and Glimmer wondered at the

softness in her voice, the tone she really only saved for Adora.

“I’ve only got one more shot!” Adora wailed, gripping the sides of her head. “Gimme a hint!”

“Hell, no,” Catra snorted. “Use your brain.”

“Nooooo,” she whined, turning on Bow. “Bow, please!”

“It’s…warm.” Was all Bow said, sipping his latte and smirking to himself. Adora chewed on that info, while Mermista slapped her pen against her head.

“C’mon, c’mon,” she muttered. “I, E, L… and an S-...Sle….Elis….Spli…SPIEL!” She dropped the pen to punch the word in, before pumping a reserved fist. “Yes, fuck yes, okay-”

Sea Hawk tossed his pen to the table, spreading his arms wide and then crossing them behind his head. “I win!”

Bow shook his head. “I finished before we even got here.”

“Nooo!” Sea Hawk’s smug air vanished as he puddled onto the table. Mermista scowled at the disruption and shoved him upright. “How! It was so long!”

“That’s what she said.” Chorused Catra, Glimmer, Mermista, and… Sea Hawk.

“I have two gods-given gifts,” Bow slurped at his frappuccino with an air of superiority. “Nice arms, and a math brain.”

“Better than whatever the gods gave Adora,” Catra was eyeing the blonde with something close to bemused incredulity. “How have you not gotten this?”

“S…Scrap?” Adora chewed her lip and jiggled her legs. “It could be scrap.”

Perfuma looked up from her bullet journal, which she'd been busying herself with since the conversation had turned to online games- she tried to limit her screen time to a (in Glimmer's opinion) absurd level for the modern century, but they all respected it. Usually. They didn't when they had ten minutes to get to the Athletic Complex and she wasn't answering her damn phone, but those moments were…rare-ish. "Adora, Bow gave you a hint, remember?"

"OH!" Adora lit up. "Warm! Warm…warm, uh…scrag? No. Scarmmmm-SCARF! It's scarf!"

The table cheered as she punched it in gleefully, nearly misspelling it in her excitement. The telling victory jingle elicited more whoops and high-fives, and Adora grabbed Catra in a hug that left the gymnast blushing red to her roots. Glimmer and Bow locked eyes again, smothering twin giggles. Catra pulled herself out of the hug and smoothed her hands over her curls, obviously flustered. Adora, bless her, was none the wiser to her friend's plight, and was instead thumbing over to Twitter to post her score.

"Well, that was an Odyssey," Bow chuckled. The waitress chose that moment to drop off everyone's food, and they lapsed into a comfortable silence as they all tucked in. Forkfuls and pieces were shared between them all, everyone long comfortable with each other. Years of shared locker-rooms, late nights and early mornings spent slumped on each others' couches, not to mention the myriad of quasi-romantic entanglements they'd all been through. They were close knit, to say the least.

"Damn it!" Mermista clicked her pen shut and tossed her phone to the table. "Who uses 'ovine'? Is that even a word? Ugh!" She stabbed her fork into Sea Hawk's breakfast scramble, and he very smartly kept his mouth shut. Glimmer snorted around a spoonful of Bow's smoothie bowl, which she was now very annoyed with herself for not ordering.

"Lost your Quordle?"

“Yemph,” Mermista muttered around sausage and egg. She turned to Sea Hawk’s plate, curious. “Is that a hash brown?”

“Yes and there’s only one,” he batted her fork away. “Order your own damn hashie.”

“Here, Mista!” Adora spoke around a mouthful of bacon. “You can have one of mine, I got three.”

“Thank you, Adora,” Mermista sniffed pointedly. “See? Some people have manners.”

Scorpia, meanwhile, was pouting. “Aw, I forgot to order a hashie.”

“Can we stop saying hashie?” Catra muttered. “It’s so stupid.”

Sea Hawk chugged a concerning amount of black coffee before smacking his lips. “Sounds like someone’s jealous they don’t have a hashie.”

“I’m going to bite you.”

“Sike, I’m into that.”

“Eugh,” Catra pantomimed barfing, sticking two fingers down her throat and gagging at Sea Hawk, who just shrugged. Adora smirked at her, rolling her eyes. “Vile as hell. Leave the premises.”

“If I order a hashie do I have to leave?” Bow chuckled.

Catra snorted. “No, but only because you’re my ride back to the Plex.”

“Yeehaw!” And only Bow, golden boy, could get away with saying that unironically. Glimmer polished off her bite of avocado toast and pulled out her phone.

“Guys, I’m gonna record for a Tiktok for later if that’s cool. I wanna jump in on the ‘my friends and their problems’ trend.”

“Are you going to be rude?” Perfuma arched a thin eyebrow.

“Uhhhhh…”

“Ruder the better,” Catra smirked. “Start another rumor scandal and get us all trending again.”

“No.”

“Absolutely not.”

“Too soon, Wildcat. Too soon.”

Catra chuckled to herself. “Ehhh I always like the cheap shots.”

“I will be as polite as you all deserve.” Glimmer said primly, much to everyone’s chagrin. She smiled at them all and started recording, starting with Adora. Her problem? Takes six tries and a hint to solve a Wordle. Bow? Too pure for this world. Catra? Where to start. Mermista? Plays Quordle for fun. Sea Hawk? Arsonist who says hashie unironically. Scorpia? Doesn’t know her own strength. Perfuma? Meditates her anger management problems away. And Glimmer? Calls these people her very best friends.

There were worse problems to have.

End Notes

Hope y’all enjoyed! Feel free to leave a comment and/or kudo, or come hit me up on Tumblr @ pointlesslypoetic or @ nastybeat

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